

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

25th MAR, 2019

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

13th WEEK



A SNAPSHOT ON GOLAN HEIGHTS

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

25th MARCH, 2019

UPSC IAS PRELIMS 2019 ... REVISION



**STAY WITH
G. V. RAO**

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NATIONAL EVENTS

IV

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BRAINSTORMING FOR PRELIMS

MODULE NO:38

23rd March, 2019

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1 Where are they, and why do they matter?

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE
NEW DELHI, MARCH 24

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP has said "it is time for the US to fully recognize Israel's sovereignty over the Golan Heights". What is this area, who lives here, and why is it contentious?

The land

The Golan Heights are a fertile plateau of around 1,300 sq km area lying to the north and east of the Sea of Galilee, which Israel seized from Syria during the Six-Day War of 1967, and has occupied ever since. The Golan overlooks both Israel and Syria, and offers a commanding military vantage. Syrian forces made an abortive bid to take it back during the Yom Kippur War of 1973; the 1974 ceasefire agreement, however, left most of the area in Israeli hands. In 1981, Israel passed the Golan Heights Law, which extended Israel's "laws, jurisdiction and administration" to the area, in effect annexing it. A UNSC resolution declaring the imposition of Israel's law "in the occupied Syrian Golan Heights... null and void and without international legal effect" has not changed



the situation on the ground, although the frontier has not seen major hostilities for more than 40 years. In 2000, Israel and Syria made

a failed attempt at negotiating a settlement.

The inhabitants

Around 50,000 people are estimated to live on the Golan, divided almost equally between Israeli Jewish settlers and Arabic-speaking Druze people of Syrian origin, who follow a monotheistic Abrahamic religion related to Israeli Shia Islam. The Druze have remained loyal to the regimes of Bashar al-Assad and his father Hafez al-Assad over the decades, and refused Israeli citizenship.

Trump's move

Trump's tweet marked a reversal of decades of US policy, which has refused to condone the Israeli occupation of Golan, and urged that the dispute must be resolved diplomatically. The President has earlier recognised the disputed city of Jerusalem as Israel's capital, moved the American Embassy there from Tel Aviv, and stopped aid to Palestinian refugees. Last year, the US voted against a ritual annual UN resolution condemning Israel's continued seizure of the Golan Heights. Because nothing is happening on Golan and nobody expects Israel to pull back in any case, Trump's tweet

does not change anything — what it does, however, is extend legitimacy to Israel's position, and boost Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's hardline agenda as he seeks a fifth term in the April 9 elections.

Strategic theatre

Israel argues that Golan is a security buffer against the war in Syria, and Netanyahu has said that if Israel were to withdraw, it would have "Iran [which backs Syria's Assad and has vowed Israel's destruction] on the shores of the Sea of Galilee". In 2014, rebel forces fighting the Assad regime took control of the Quneitra province on the Syrian side of Golan, but government forces took back the territory last year, and began facilitating the return of UN troops to their positions. The United Nations Disengagement Observer Force (UNDOF) and United Nations Truce Supervision Organisation (UNTSO) have camps and posts in the area. The Israeli and Syrian armies are separated by a 400 sq km demilitarized zone which neither side can enter. There is a solitary crossing, which, before the beginning of the civil war in Syria, was used by UN forces, Druze civilians, and to transport agricultural produce.

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora.

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

Critically analyze various actions of the USA, which makes solution to Israel - Palestine Conflict quite complex.

 **The Indian EXPRESS**
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE
25th March, 2019

1 Where are they, and why do they matter?

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President Donald Trump has said “it is time for the US to fully recognize Israel’s sovereignty over the Golan Heights”. What is this area, who lives here, and why is it contentious?

The land

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1 Where are they, and why do they matter?

...Contd.

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Around 50,000 people are estimated to live on the Golan, divided almost equally between Israeli Jewish settlers and Arabic-speaking Druze people of Syrian origin, who follow a monotheistic Abrahamic religion related to Ismaili Shia Islam. The Druze have remained loyal to the regimes of Bashar al-Assad and his father Hafez al-Assad over the decades, and refused Israeli citizenship.

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Trump's tweet marked a reversal of decades of US policy, which has refused to condone the Israeli occupation of Golan, and urged that the dispute must be resolved diplomatically. The President has earlier recognised the disputed city of Jerusalem as Israel's capital, moved the American Embassy there from Tel Aviv, and stopped aid to Palestinian refugees. Last year, the US voted against a ritual annual UN resolution condemning Israel's continued seizure of the Golan Heights. Because nothing is happening on Golan and nobody expects Israel to pull back in any case, Trump's tweet does not change anything — what it does, however, is extend legitimacy to Israel's position, and boost Israeli Prime Minister Binyamin Netanyahu's hardline agenda as he seeks a fifth term in the April 9 elections.

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...Contd.

Strategic theatre

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- Golan Heights is the fertile plateau of around 1,300 sq km.
- It is north and east of the Sea of Galilee.
- Recently, the President, Donald Trump said it is time for the US to fully recognize Israel's sovereignty over the Golan Heights.

HISTORY OF GOLAN HEIGHTS!



1 It is the fertile plateau, Israel seized from Syria during the Six-Day War of 1967, it occupied it since then.

2 It overlooks both Syria and Israel, it gives a commanding military vantage.

3 Syrian forces made an unsuccessful attempt to take it back during the Yom Kippur War of 1973.

4 The 1974 Ceasefire Agreement, left most of the area in Israeli hands.

5 In 1981, Israel passed the Golan Heights Law, which extended Israel's Laws, Jurisdiction and Administration to the area, that means, it annexed it in 1981.



WHAT THE UNITED NATIONS SECURITY COUNCIL RESOLUTION SAID?



1 Around 50,000 people are estimated to live on the Golan Heights, divided equally between Israeli Jewish settlers and Arabic-speaking Druze people of Syrian origin, who follow a monotheistic Abrahamic religion related to Ismaili Shia Islam.

2 It declared the imposition of Israel's law in the occupied Syrian Golan Heights as null and void and without international legal effect.

3 It has not changed the situation on the ground.

4 In 2000, Israel and Syria made a failed attempt at negotiating a settlement.

Trump's tweet marked a reversal of decades of US policy, which refused to condone the Israeli occupation of Golan Heights.

WHAT ARE THE US ACTIONS IN RECENT TIMES, WHICH MAKES THE CONFLICT A COMPLEX ISSUE?

LIVE

DONALD TRUMP
President, US



Israeli and Syrian armies are separated by a 400 sq km demilitarized zone, which neither side can enter and Israel argues that Golan Heights is a security buffer against the war in Syria.

- 1** US now gave the statement that it is going to fully recognize Israel's sovereignty over the Golan Heights.
- 2** USA previously recognised the disputed city of Jerusalem as Israel's capital.
- 3** USA moved the American Embassy from Tel Aviv to Jerusalem, it stopped aid to Palestinian refugees.
- 4** Last year, US voted against a ritual annual UN Resolution condemning Israel's continued seizure of Golan Heights.

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